

Thomas Hazell

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Education

DPHil (PhD) in Politics

2024 –

Department of Politics and International Relations, University of Oxford

Funded by an Economic and Social Research Council Studentship. Supervised by Dr Katerina Tertytchnaya.

Visiting Graduate Student

March – April 2026

PSIR, Nazarbayev University, Astana

MPhil in Politics (Comparative Government)

2022 – 2024

Department of Politics and International Relations, University of Oxford

Grade: *Distinction*.

BA in Philosophy, Politics, and Economics

2019 – 2022

Lincoln College, University of Oxford

Grade: *First Class*.

Work-in-Progress

'Personnel appointments in authoritarian bureaucracies'. *Working paper*.

'Social connections and the quality of public procurement'. *In progress*.

'Which merits matter? Political performance, economic meritocracy, and elite loyalty in authoritarian states'. *Working paper*.

'The governance effects of local elections in autocracies'. With Kirill Melnikov and Eleonora Minaeva. *Working paper*.

'Local elections and elite management in authoritarian regimes: evidence from Kazakhstan'. With Eleonora Minaeva and Kirill Melnikov. *Working paper*.

'Shuffling to co-opt: Subnational governance, co-optation, and political careers in Kazakhstan'. *Working paper*.

Conferences, Workshops & Talks

'Personnel appointments in authoritarian bureaucracies.' 20 March 2026. Department of Political Science and International Relations, Nazarbayev University, Astana.

'Which merits matter? Political performance, economic meritocracy, and elite loyalty in authoritarian states.' *Conference of the European Political Science Association (EPSA)*. 27 June 2025. UC3M, Madrid.

'Personnel appointments in authoritarian bureaucracies.' *3rd APSG Conference on Authoritarian Politics*. 23 June 2025. Authoritarian Political Systems Group, King's College London.

'Personnel appointments in authoritarian bureaucracies.' *3rd Conference "New Advances in the Political Economy of Development in Eurasia."* 6 June 2025. Almaty Management University, Almaty.

'Shuffling to co-opt: Subnational governance, patronage, and political careers in Kazakhstan.' *Conference of the Midwestern Political Science Association (MPSA)*. 5 April 2025. Chicago.

'Shuffling to co-opt: Subnational governance, patronage, and political careers in Kazakhstan.' *ESRC Grand Union DTP Annual Conference*. 4 June 2024. University of Oxford, Oxford.

'Shuffling to co-opt: Subnational governance, patronage, and political careers in Kazakhstan.' *Emerging Scholars Workshop on the Study of Challenges in Eurasian Politics and Society*. 24 May 2024. Center for Slavic, Eurasian, and East European Studies, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill. Presented Online.

Teaching

Undergraduate Tutor *University of Oxford*

Comparative Government, Politics in Russia and the Former Soviet Union

Professional & Research Experience

Research Assistant on Non-Violent Repression in Electoral Autocracies

September 2024 – present

Department of Politics and International Relations, University of Oxford

Election Observer (Short-term), Uzbekistan

October 2024

OSCE ODIHR Election Observation Mission

Consultant Researcher (open source methods)

June – October 2024

Ridgeway Information, London

Research Assistant on AUTHLIB (PI: Stephen Whitefield) September 2023 – January 2024

Department of Politics and International Relations, University of Oxford

Research Assistant to Dr Lenka Bušíková

May – September 2023

Oxford School of Global and Area Studies, University of Oxford

Research Assistant on the Oxford University Economic Recovery Project

February –

November 2021

Smith School of Energy and Enterprise, University of Oxford

Intern

Summer 2021

Oxford Internet Institute, University of Oxford

Service

Reviewer for *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties* and *Communist and Post-Communist Studies*.

Languages

English (Native). Russian (Intermediate). Qazaq (Beginner).

Computer Skills

R (Advanced): Modelling & causal inference methods. Survey data. Visualisation. Managing large datasets. Web scraping/automation. Quarto. Machine learning (`tidymodels`). GIS (`sf`).

Python (Basic): Scraping. Data management. Natural language processing/text-as-data/machine learning, including `torch`. GIS.

Other: OpenAI APIs (Batch, Fine Tuning). Git/GitHub. Cloud computing (Azure, Google Cloud). Databases/basic SQL. $\LaTeX$.